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STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

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Document ID:	SOP-REG-001
Title:	Canadian Food Label Compliance Assessment Procedure
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Author:	Simran Saran

1. PURPOSE

To establish a standardized procedure for assessing consumer food product labels for compliance with Canadian Food & Drug Regulations (FDR), CFIA Industry Labelling Tool requirements, and Front-of-Package (FOP) nutrition symbol regulations.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies to all prepackaged consumer food products sold in Canada. It covers assessment of:

- Ingredient statement compliance
- Nutrition Facts Table (NFT) accuracy
- Priority allergen declarations
- FOP nutrition symbol requirements
- Nutrient content claims substantiation
- Bilingual labelling compliance

3. REFERENCES

- Food and Drugs Act (FDA) & Food and Drug Regulations (FDR), specifically:
 - B.01.008.2 (Ingredient lists)
 - B.01.010.1 (Priority allergen declaration)
 - B.01.350 (Nutrition Facts Table)
 - B.01.503 (Nutrient content claims)
- Safe Food for Canadians Act (SFCA) & Regulations (SFCR)
- CFIA Industry Labelling Tool
- Health Canada FOP Nutrition Symbol Amendments (Canada Gazette Part II, July 2022)

4. DEFINITIONS

FOP: Front-of-Package nutrition symbol (magnifying glass)

NFT: Nutrition Facts Table

DV: Daily Value

FDR: Food and Drug Regulations

CAPA: Corrective and Preventive Action

Priority Allergens (Canada): eggs, milk, mustard, peanuts, crustaceans/shellfish, fish, sesame seeds, soy, sulphites, tree nuts, wheat/triticale, molluscs

FOP Threshold: Product must display FOP symbol if saturated fat, sugars, OR sodium $\geq$ 15% Daily Value

5. PROCEDURE

5.1 SAMPLE COLLECTION

- a) Obtain physical product from retail location
- b) Photograph: front panel, ingredient list, NFT,
and allergen statement
- c) Record product name, UPC, size, and date

5.2 INGREDIENT STATEMENT ASSESSMENT

- a) Verify ingredients listed in descending order
of proportion
- b) Confirm common names used (per FDR B.01.008.2)
- c) Verify sub-ingredients are properly bracketed
- d) Check sugar-based ingredients are grouped under
"Sugars" parenthetical (per 2016 FDR amendments)
- e) Confirm bilingual (English and French)

5.3 NUTRITION FACTS TABLE ASSESSMENT

- a) Verify all mandatory nutrients are listed
- b) Confirm serving size follows CFIA reference amounts
- c) Check % Daily Value calculations
- d) Record % DV for saturated fat, sodium, and sugars
(needed for FOP assessment in Step 5.4)

5.4 FOP NUTRITION SYMBOL ASSESSMENT

a) From NFT, determine if any of the following

≥ 15% Daily Value:

- Saturated fat
- Sugars
- Sodium

b) If YES to any → FOP symbol is REQUIRED

c) Inspect principal display panel for presence
of magnifying glass FOP symbol

d) If required but absent → document as
NON-COMPLIANCE

e) If FOP symbol is present, check whether any
nutrient content claims on the package conflict
with FOP restrictions

5.5 ALLERGEN DECLARATION ASSESSMENT

a) Review ingredient list for all 12 priority
allergens and their derivatives

b) Verify "Contains:" statement lists all priority
allergens present

c) Check for derivative forms (e.g., lactose → milk,
lecithin → soy, whey → milk)

d) Confirm allergen declaration is bilingual

e) Note any "May contain:" precautionary statements

5.6 CLAIMS SUBSTANTIATION

a) Identify all claims on the package (nutrient

- content claims, health claims, composition claims)
- b) Cross-reference each claim against FDR thresholds
- c) If product carries FOP symbol, verify claim is
not restricted under the new amendments
- d) Document substantiation status for each claim

5.7 BILINGUAL COMPLIANCE

- a) Verify all mandatory information appears in both
English and French
- b) Check: product name, ingredient list, NFT,
allergen statement, claims, net quantity

5.8 DOCUMENTATION

- a) Record all findings in Compliance Assessment Matrix
- b) Rate each category: Compliant / Minor Gap /
Non-Compliant
- c) Generate CAPA report for any non-conformances
- d) Archive label photographs with assessment records

6. DOCUMENTATION

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- Compliance Assessment Matrix (spreadsheet)
 - CAPA Reports (as required)
 - Product label photographs (archived)
 - This SOP document

7. REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Change Description
1.0	April 2026	Initial release